

MODERN CRM

From Campaigns to Conversations

JANUARY 2026

Campaigns live in channels.
Conversations live *across* them



Growth comes in waves

PAST

**OPERATIONAL
EFFICIENCY**

**REMOVE
FRICTION**

**OPTIMIZE
TRANSACTIONS**

NOW

**PERSONALIZED
ENGAGEMENT**

**INCREASE
RELEVANCE**

**CHANNEL
PERFORMANCE**

FUTURE

**ADAPTIVE
INTELLIGENCE**

**RELATIONSHIP
ORCHESTRATION**

**RETURN ON
RELATIONSHIP**

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**The next wave is coming.
Are you ready?**

Why Modern
CRM Matters,
Right Now.

The forces driving the next wave...

RISING CPA

60%

Increase in customer acquisition costs in the past 5 years

- Business Wire

1PD CHALLENGE

37%

of US brands say their greatest concern or challenge is having enough first-party data for targeting, activation, etc.

- IAB

PERSONALIZATION EXPECTATION

72%

of consumers expect the businesses they buy from to recognize them as individuals and know their interests

- McKinsey

CLICK & MORTAR

84%

of consumers believe retailers should be doing more to integrate their online and offline channels

- RetailNext

BRAND MANDATE

Reduce CAC and drive growth from existing customer base.

Incentivize data sharing at the individual level.

Connect touchpoints for a seamless, consistent experience.

Recognize and reward consumers across interactions.

**Investments in
CRM technology
modernization
have reached
record levels.**

\$84B

Global CRM tech.
spend in 2025

+15%

Forecast global CRM
tech. spend in 2026

**But
organizational
transformation
continues to lag.**

Marketing owns growth but can't deliver alone

Technology owns platforms but not outcomes

Operations owns execution but lacks insight

Product owns features but not relationships

Modern CRM becomes mission-critical when growth, retention, and experience accountability cut across marketing, technology, and operations.

Most organizations still plan around products and channels, while customers experience brands by need, moment, and context.

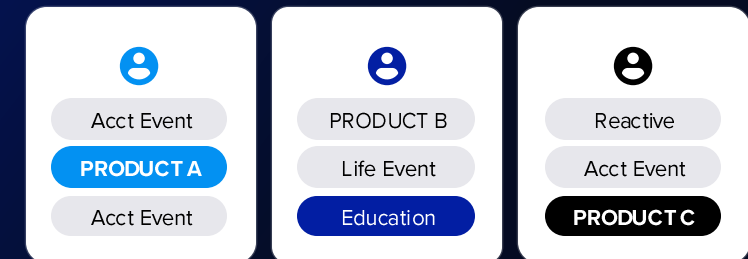
Start with the product or channel

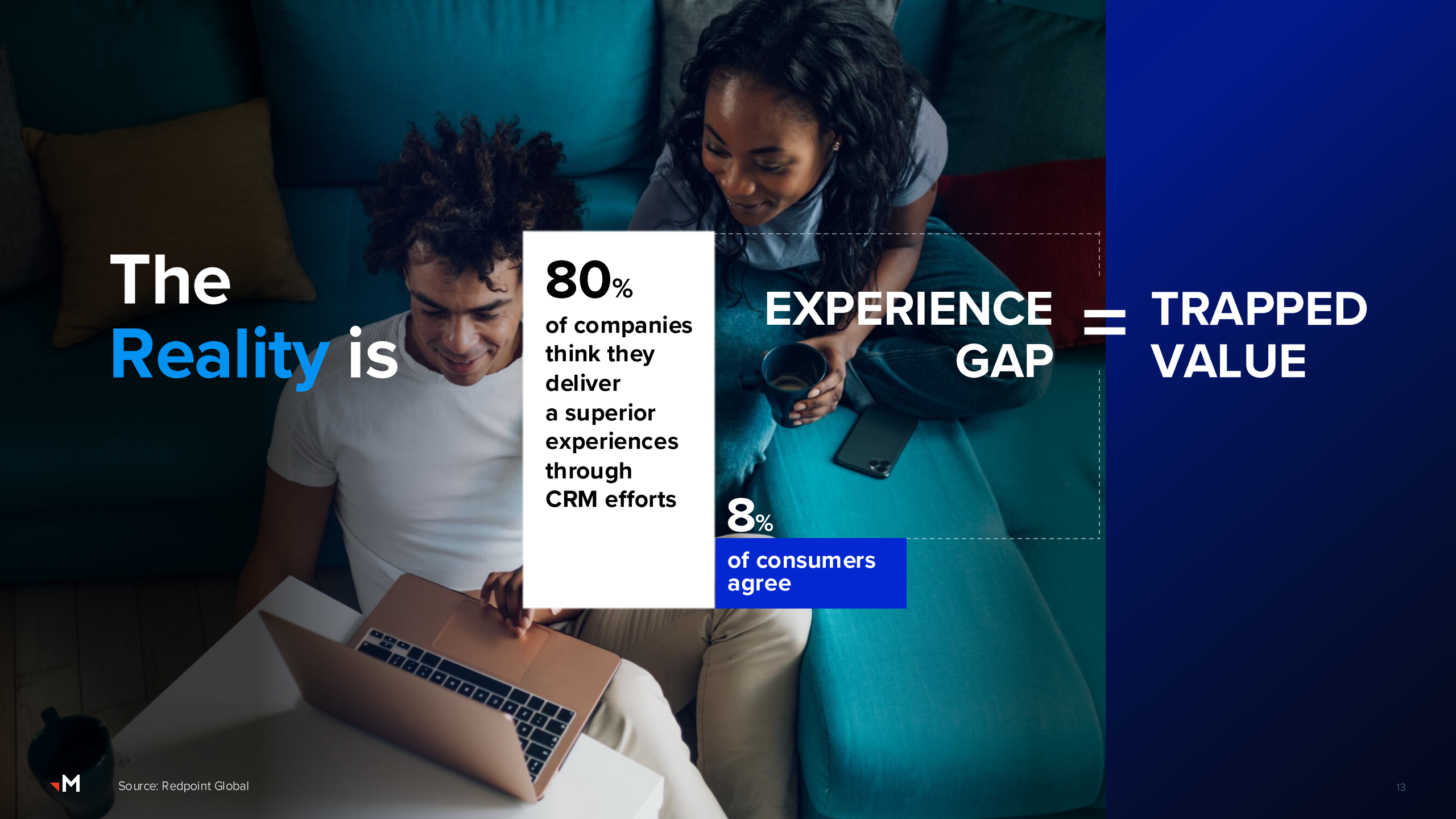
and then broadcast offers to the largest set of likely customers



Start with segment based, behavioral insights about your audience

then determine the right product, guidance, or experience





The
Reality is

80%
of companies
think they
deliver
a superior
experiences
through
CRM efforts

8%

of consumers
agree

EXPERIENCE GAP = TRAPPED VALUE

Millions in trapped value sit across the enterprise

Margin Erosion



Disconnected data drives inefficient spend.

IMPACT

1 in 3 marketing dollars is wasted due to incomplete, duplicated, or poorly integrated customer data.

Experience Degradation



Redundant journeys create friction and fatigue.

70% of consumers say brands don't understand them, often due to irrelevant or repetitive engagement.

Missed Revenue



Late or missed intent recognition stalls growth.

Acquiring new customers costs 3–5x more than growing existing ones, yet **intent is often recognized too late.**

Everyday Moments Where The Customer Experience Breaks

TELECOM

A customer upgrades their device and runs into setup issues.

They contact support and wait for the issue to be resolved.

While the problem is unresolved, they receive promotional offers for device insurance and home internet.

The issue feels secondary to selling — and trust erodes.

Everyday Moments Where The Customer Experience Breaks

AUTO

A customer configures a vehicle online, shares details during a call, and schedules a dealer appointment.

When they arrive, the dealer has no visibility into the configuration, the call, or prior brand purchases.

The customer has to repeat themselves.

Momentum is lost — and confidence drops.

Everyday Moments Where The Customer Experience Breaks

02

03

04

BANKING

A long-time customer shows signs of increased income and emerging credit needs.

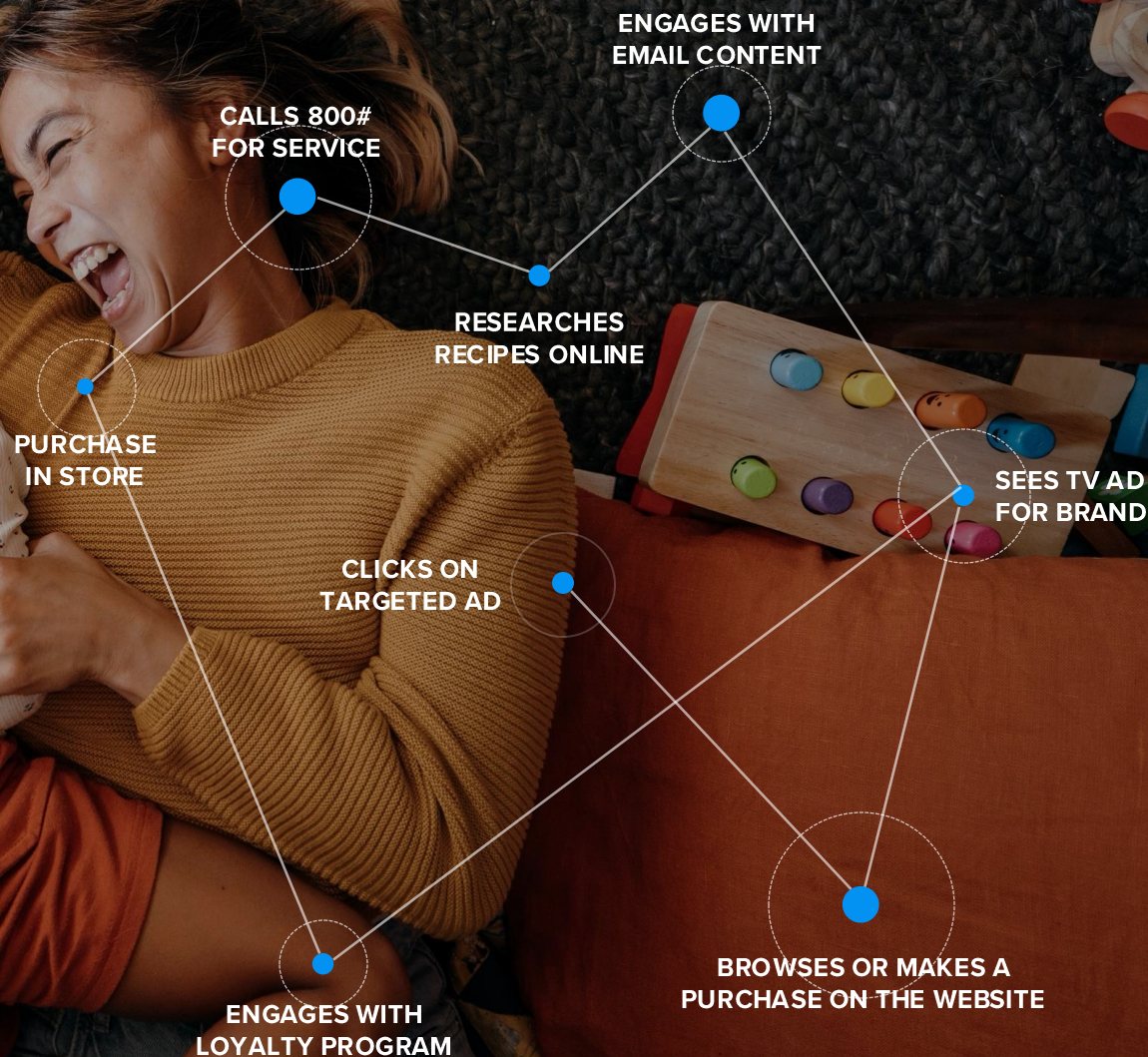
Those signals live across different product teams, each focused on their own goals.

No one connects the dots or reaches out in context.

A high-value moment passes unnoticed — and growth stalls.

Modern CRM Transformation

**Modern CRM is
an enterprise
operating model
that orchestrates
connected interactions
across every
touchpoint.**



Modern CRM unlocks value by breaking down planning, data and technology silos.

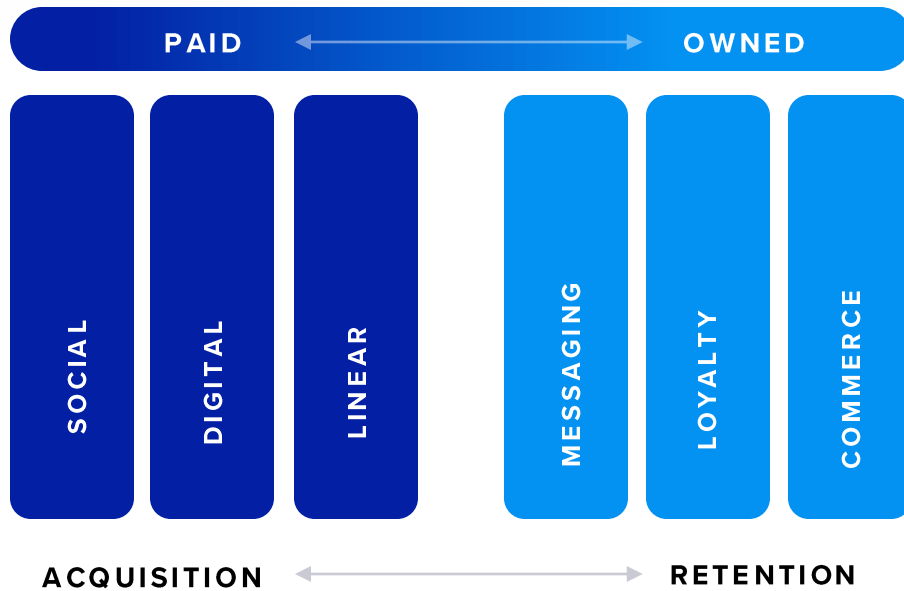
Independent Channel Planning	→	Holistic Audience Planning
Calendar, Segments, Promos	→	Identity, Signals, Intent
Disconnected Point Solutions	→	Connected Composable Ecosystems
Legacy Processes	→	Streamlined Operating Models
Static Insights	→	Adaptive Intelligence
Fragmented Communications	→	Always-on Engagement

Moving from channel optimization to relationship optimization

TRADITIONAL CRM

Powers *Siloed* Campaigns

Focus: Product or Channel Optimization



MODERN CRM

Powers *Connected* Conversations

Focus: Relationship Optimization





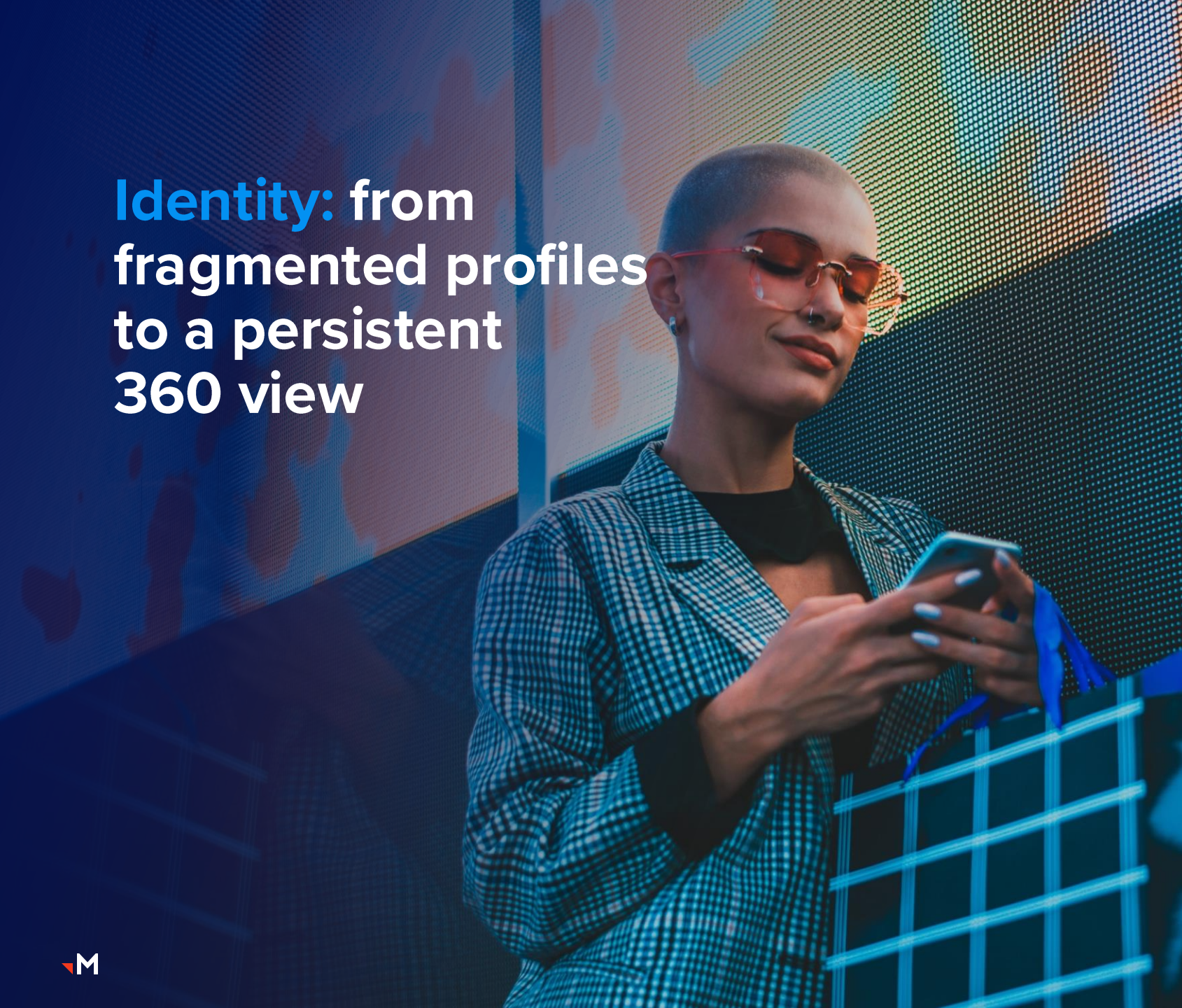
Together Identity and AI are at the heart of Modern CRM

IDENTITY

Identity creates a persistent understanding of the customer.

AI

AI accelerates our ability to turn understanding into action.



Identity: from fragmented profiles to a persistent 360 view

MODERN CRM IDENTITY APPLICATIONS

IDENTITY CONNECTS

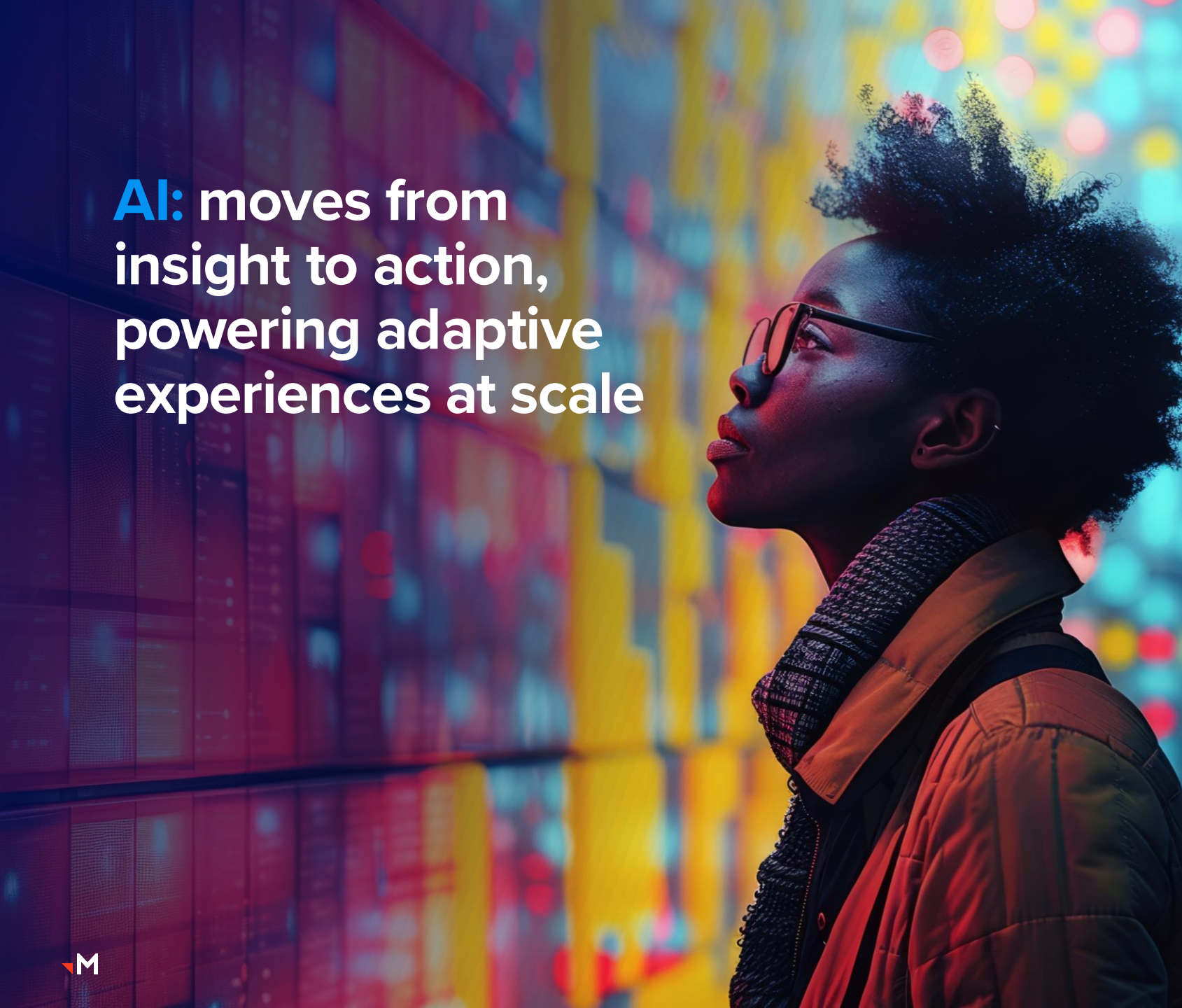
known and anonymous data into a single, persistent record that travels with the customer across channels, devices, and business units.

IDENTITY RECOGNIZES

more anonymous users and enables us to react to audience intent signals in real-time.

IDENTITY EXTENDS

CRM beyond traditional owned channels and into new addressable paid and earned environments



AI: moves from
insight to action,
powering adaptive
experiences at scale

MODERN CRM AI APPLICATIONS

1

PREDICTIVE AI

NBX models enable us to act on customer need before they ask.

2

GENERATIVE AI

Every interaction builds on the last, creating seamless journeys across touchpoints

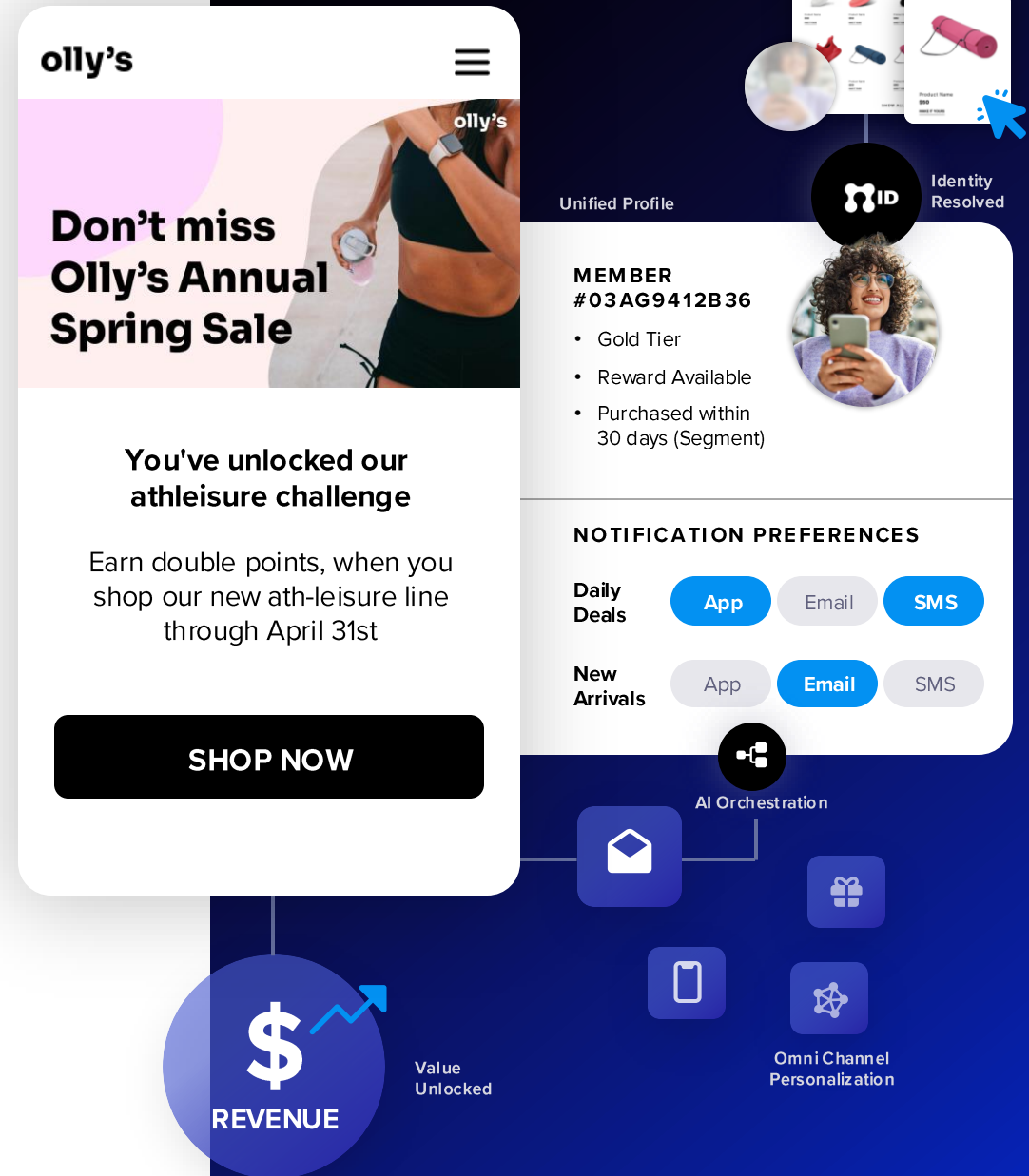
3

AGENTIC AI

1-to-1 experiences delivered to millions, powered by aways on AI agents

Creating a single brand experience adaptive to **relationship, channel and intent**

- Identifying anonymous users and linking them to a unified profile
- Connecting signals to decisions through AI-driven orchestration.
- Unifying media, marketing, sales, and service around the customer.
- Unlocking trapped value by driving a greater return on relationship.



The Same Moments — When Modern CRM Orchestrates the Relationship

TELECOM

A customer upgrades their device and runs into setup issues.

Modern CRM recognizes the service event and shares context across marketing and support.

The customer receives reassurance, status updates, and a small loyalty gesture while the issue is resolved.

The problem is addressed — and trust is preserved.

The Same Moments — When Modern CRM Orchestrates the Relationship

AUTO

A customer configures a vehicle online, shares details during a call, and schedules a dealer appointment.

Modern CRM carries intent, preferences, and history across digital, call center, and dealer systems.

The dealer continues the conversation seamlessly, without repetition.

Momentum is maintained — and confidence turns into conversion.

The Same Moments — When Modern CRM Orchestrates the Relationship

02

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04

BANKING

A long-time customer shows signals of increased income and emerging credit needs.

Modern CRM connects signals across products and assigns clear ownership of the relationship.

The bank proactively engages with relevant guidance at the right moment.

A missed opportunity becomes relationship growth.

Accelerating growth across the customer lifecycle.



Identify & Know

Unify data and signals across paid, owned, and behavioral sources to build a single, actionable customer or account view.



Engage & Convert

Deliver relevant, personalized experiences across the journey that build trust and accelerate conversion.



Retain & Grow

Strengthen long-term relationships through value recognition, predictive insights, and personalized engagement.

Unlocking value across the entire enterprise

3-6%

Increase in
customer retention

20-30%

Improvement in
media efficiency

2-4x

Increase in Customer
Lifetime Value

5-15%

Lift in key
customer journeys

Sources: PwC, Adobe/CMO.com, FloQast, dentsu

Getting Started with Modern CRM

Aligning around the customer requires more than technology

Modern CRM is not a platform decision, it's an **enterprise operating system** that aligns marketing, data, technology, and process around the customer.



MARKETING

From Channel Plans to Customer Outcomes

74%

of companies still have critical customer insights outside centralized systems — and only ~31% say their data is AI-ready

WHAT SHOULD LEADERS LOOK FOR

- Planning organized by journeys and segments, not channels
- Clear definition of priority customer moments
- Shared success metrics tied to outcomes (adoption, retention, value)



DATA

From disconnected signals to actionable insight

70%

of organizations have significant gaps between planning alignment and cross-functional execution.

WHAT SHOULD LEADERS LOOK FOR

- Unified identity across known and anonymous users
- Early intent signals surfaced in time to act
- Teams share a common view of customer readiness, risk, and value.



TECH

From point solutions to orchestrated capabilities

47%

of martech leaders say stack complexity and integration challenges are blocking value.

WHAT SHOULD LEADERS LOOK FOR

- CRM, loyalty, messaging, media, and service working together
- Real-time decisioning across systems
- Technology enabling speed, not manual stitching



TECH

From point solutions to orchestrated capabilities

Less than

30%

of martech leaders say stack complexity and integration challenges are blocking value.

WHAT SHOULD LEADERS LOOK FOR

- Clear ownership of priority journeys
- Decisions made by customer outcome, not function
- Measurement shifting from campaign KPIs to Return on Relationship





We can help you ride the wave of growth



Unlocking trapped value with our Modern CRM workshop

A structured working session designed to identify, quantify, and prioritize enterprise growth opportunities.

Priority Journeys and high value use cases

A short list of customer journeys that are worth fixing first and clarity on why they matter.

Required data and technology alignment

Clear visibility into what data and technology are needed to power high-value experiences and what's missing or underutilized today.

Operating model friction

A practical view of what must change in roles, ownership, and ways of working to support customer-centric execution.

A Quantified, prioritized value roadmap

A value-backed roadmap that aligns investment, effort, and outcomes, making it easier to fund, sequence, and act with confidence.

Workshop: Unlocking Trapped Value

A structured working session designed to identify, quantify, and prioritize enterprise growth opportunities



	What We Do	What You Get	Why It Matters
PRIORITY JOURNEYS	Identify the customer journeys and moments where friction, waste, or missed opportunity exist	A short list of priority journeys sized by impact on retention, conversion, churn, and experience quality	Focuses investment on the moments that materially move revenue, loyalty, and lifetime value
HIGH VALUE USE CASES	Define what the business should recognize, decide, and do differently in those moments	Clearly defined use cases mapped to business KPIs (revenue lift, cost reduction, CX improvement)	Translates strategy into actions that can be funded, built, and measured
DATA SIGNALS	Prioritize the identity, behavioral, and intent signals required to power each use case	A ranked list of critical data signals with gaps, latency, and duplication identified	Prevents over-engineering and focuses data investment on ROI-driving signals
TECH ALIGNMENT	Assess how existing platforms support (or limit) the prioritized use cases	Clear view of under-utilized tools, overlaps, and where orchestration or integration unlocks value	Maximizes return on existing technology spend before adding new platforms
OPERATING MODEL	Clarify journey ownership, decision rights, and cross-team dependencies	Defined ownership model and operating changes required to sustain impact	Ensures value is not re-trapped by silos, process friction, or unclear accountability

Value Roadmap

Clear financial impact, prioritized initiatives, and a path to execution



	Estimated Revenue Upside	Estimated Cost Savings	Prioritized Value Roadmap	Why It Matters
WHAT IT REPRESENTS	Modeled revenue impact by journey and use case	Reduction in waste, inefficiency, and duplication	Initiatives ranked by value vs. effort	Defensible foundation for funding and execution decisions
HOW IT'S QUANTIFIED	Retention lift, conversion uplift, CLV expansion	Media efficiency, cost-to-serve, operational savings	Value × effort scoring across CX, Data, Tech, Org	Financial impact, dependencies, and readiness assessment
DATA SIGNALS	Focuses growth on the moments that matter most	Frees budget trapped in silos and redundancy	Creates clarity on what to do first and why	Enables confident executive decision-making

Modern CRM in Action



Modern CRM in practice

Driving better outcomes with an integrated approach

Use media to acquire new loyalty and CRM members

We launched a media campaign across owned and paid channels featuring Dolly Parton to encourage customers to join the loyalty program.

2.5M

Loyalty enrollments in two months following launch, **3x greater than projections.**

Use loyalty data to improve media targeting and reduce costs

First-party data from our loyalty program enhances segmentation, targeting, and look-alike audience modeling, resulting in higher site visit rates and media cost efficiencies.

Drive purchase and data collection through gamified experiences

Games, chances to win, and promotional pulses drive retail traffic, menu trials, digital behaviors, and excitement throughout the year and at key seasonal moments.

3M

Purchases by loyalty program members in the **first eight weeks of the program.**

148%

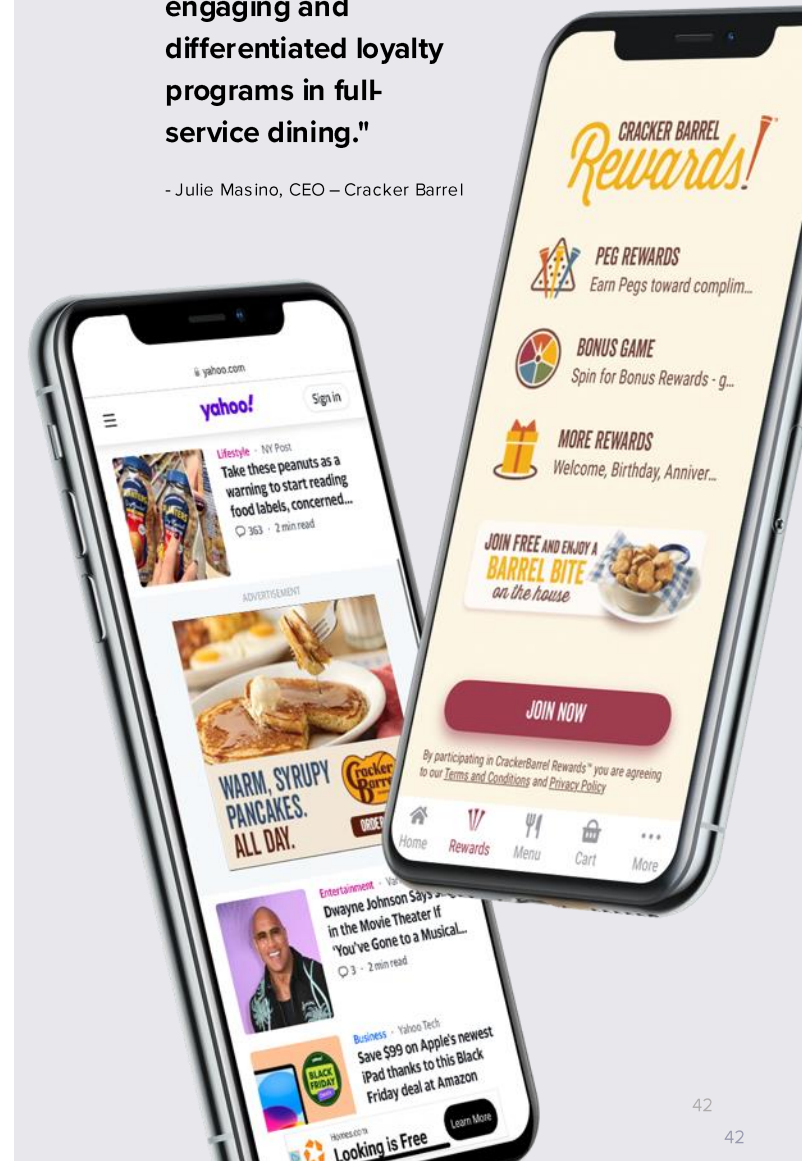
Higher rate of visitation with loyalty look-alike audience.

41%

Increased display media cost efficiency with loyalty look-alike audience.

“ We believe we have one of the most engaging and differentiated loyalty programs in full-service dining.”

- Julie Masino, CEO – Cracker Barrel



Internal Enablement

Sales Enablement Cheat Sheet: Modern CRM

BUYER AUDIENCE

CMO, CTO/CIO, CDO

VP Marketing, VP Loyalty, VP CRM

Directors of Brand, Loyalty, Marketing Strategy, Messaging

WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

- “We need to bring down the cost of media”
- “Our cost-per-acquisition is too high”
- “I want to use the customer data I have more effectively”
- “My org needs to work from a more customer-centric view”
- “Engagement with our loyalty/CRM program has plateaued”
- “We are going through digital transformation”
- “How do we make above-the-line and below-the-line media work better together?”
- “Is AI/ML mature enough to support our use cases?”

OUTCOMES THAT MATTER

- Cost of Acquisition
- Return on Ad Spend
- Customer Lifetime Value
- Conversion
- Incremental Revenue from Triggered Messaging
- Customer Retention/Churn Prevention
- Relationship Measurement Across Dimensions
- Performance of Personalized CTAs
- Database Growth
- Time Spend with the Brand
- Advocacy
- Ability to Generate Insights / Real-Time
- Reduced Operating Costs with Best of Breed Tech

All Modern CRM info you need to start a conversation

GTM CONTENT

Modern CRM

[LINK](#)

Foundational Offerings

[LINK](#)

CASE STUDIES

Burger King

**CRM, Gamification,
Loyalty Partnerships**

[LINK](#)

JC Penney

**Intelligent
Messaging**

[LINK](#)

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP



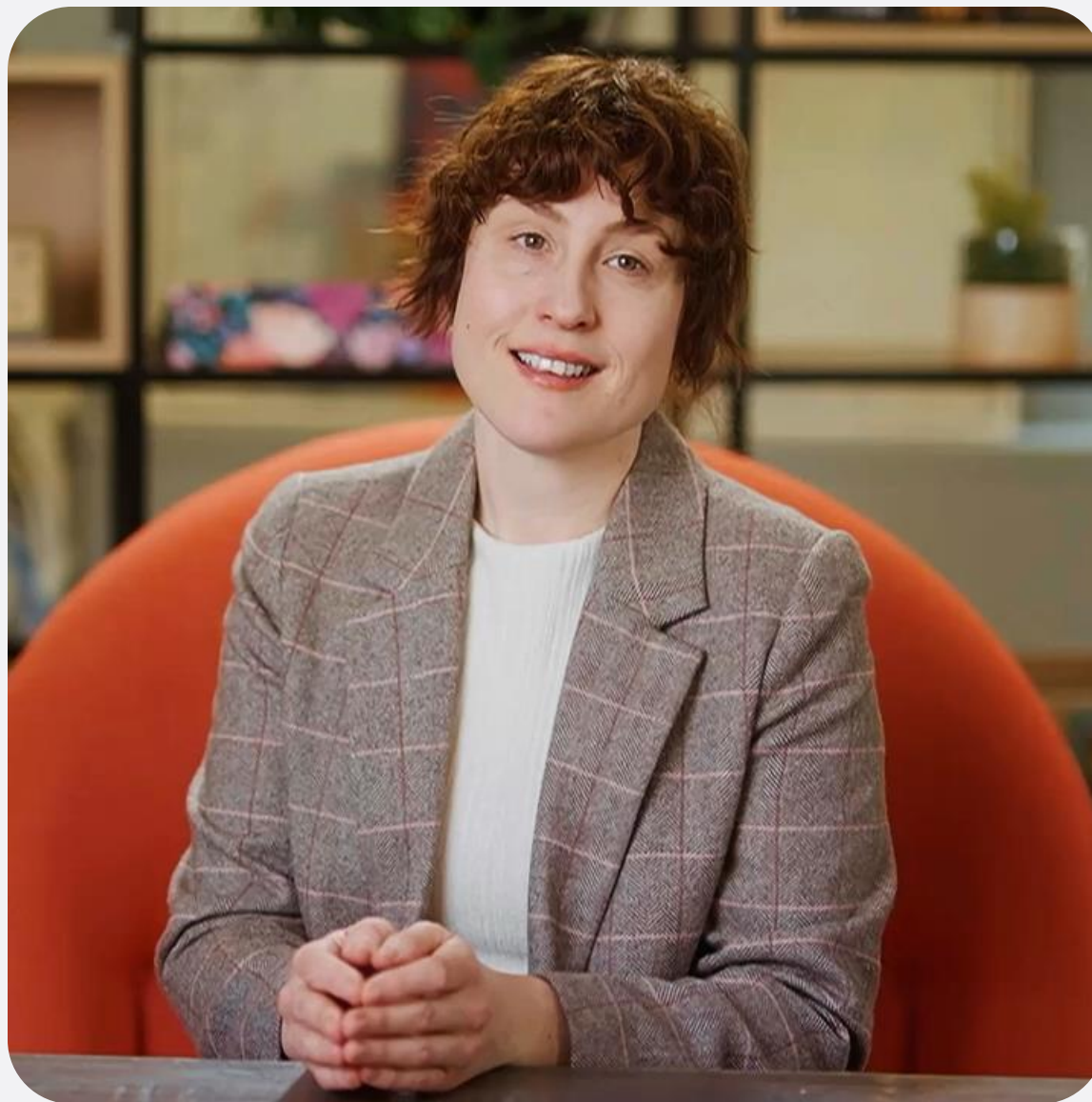
**Modern CRM
eBook**

[LINK](#)



**Loyalty
Barometer Report**

[LINK](#)



Market Contacts

MODERN CRM



David Novak
Global Head
of CRM



James Riess
SVP, GM Loyalty &
Messaging Experience

LOYALTY



James Riess
GM Loyalty & CRM
Experience



Kaitlyn Mitchell
SVP, Head of Promotions
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PROMOTIONS



Jen Gray
GM, Promotions &
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Caron Whitener
SVP, Client Services
Promotions & Loyalty

GAMIFICATION



Jen Gray
GM, Promotions &
Gamification / Creative



Kinley Clifford
VP Head of Experience
Design Consulting,
Gamification & Loyalty

MESSAGING



Erin Kelsh
VP, Messaging Solutions
& Innovation



Lisa Burgess
SVP, Messaging
Delivery Lead

Sales Support

If you need resources for an opportunity, pursuit, or client meeting, there is a defined process for requesting support:

- You **must have a Salesforce opportunity and a qualification brief** with enough information to understand your support needs and justify resourcing.
- For Pursuit or Info Design support **complete the [CRG Orchestration & Enablement Request Form](#)** with the appropriate sub-practice selected. Pursuit support requests will be available in SFDC mid-August.
- **SOS will review** your request along with your **opportunity brief and assign resources accordingly.**

This process is critical for capacity planning.

Without a consistent source of requests, teams are under-resourced to support priority work.

Self-Service Resources

[GTM Hub](#)

[Thought Leadership Portal](#)

[Case Studies Page](#)

[Marketing Campaign Hub](#)

[Merkle 2U](#)

Let's Talk! You should engage us when...

Your Client's Loyalty

- Only rewards transactions
- Flat or declining engagement
- Feels undifferentiated
- Technology is holding them back
- Low redemption or engagement
- No personalization or member segmentation
- Not aligned with brand purpose or customer expectations
- Lacks mobile or digital experience
- Competitors have more advanced programs
- **Have no connection to promotions, messaging and media**

Your Client's Promotions

- Are just discounts
- No clear promotion strategy
- Over-reliance on mass promotions
- No link to first-party data
- Hard to launch or scale quickly
- Low participation or conversion rates
- Promotions aren't driving incrementality
- No gamification or interactivity
- No test-and-learn discipline
- **Have no connection to loyalty, messaging and media**

Your Client's Messaging

- Messages are one-size-fits-all
- Low open or click-through rates
- No real-time or trigger-based messaging
- Over-reliance on batch-and-blast
- Lack of cross-channel coordination
- No personalization beyond first name
- Messaging isn't driving business outcomes
- Campaigns take too long to launch
- Inconsistent brand voice or experience
- **Have no connection to promotions, loyalty and Media**

